



Diploma in

Leadership and Management

Adaptive Leadership



Discuss the concept of adaptive leadership <

Explore the key elements of adaptive leadership <

Objectives



Adaptive leadership explained

Adaptive leadership explained

Adaptive leadership is a practical leadership framework that helps individuals and organisations adapt and thrive in challenging environments. It is being able, both individually and collectively, to take on the gradual but meaningful process of change.





Technical vs adaptive problems

Adaptive leadership recognises that there are two kinds of problems: technical and adaptive.

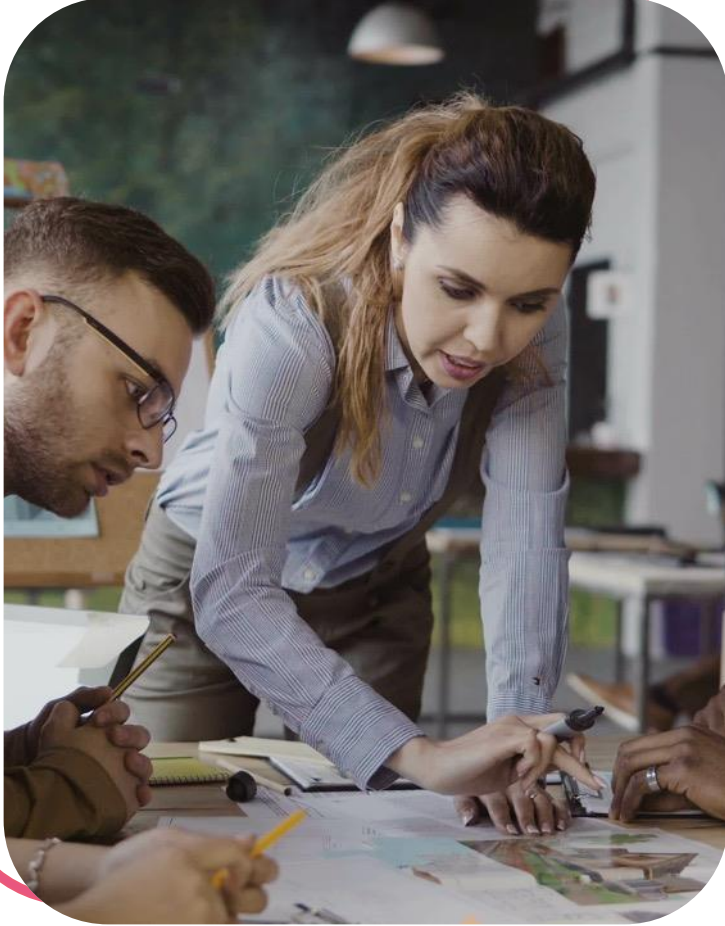
Technical problems:

- Easy to identify
- Often lend themselves to quick and concrete solutions
- Often can be solved by an authority or expert
- People are generally receptive to technical solutions
- Technical solutions can often be implemented quickly—even by decree
- Mitting belief systems

Adaptive challenges:

- Difficult to identify and easy to deny
- When leaders are solving adaptive challenges, they need to think systemically in order to understand the whole array of actors involved - they need to understand the root causes which will require committing time and energy
- Require changes in values, beliefs, roles, relationships, and approaches to how to accomplish goals
- People with the problem are the main actors who need to do the work of solving it
- Require change in numerous places; usually across organisational boundaries - therefore requires systems thinking
- People often resist while acknowledging the existence of the adaptive challenge





Main principles of adaptive leadership

- Emotional intelligence
- Organisational justice
- Development
- Character



Traits of adaptive leadership

- See the link
- Create the environment
- Realize that change is tough
- Realize that change is gradual
- Be proactive
- Admit to mistakes
- Take risks





Elements of adaptive leadership



Challenges when implementing adaptative leadership

As predicted by Heifetz, adaptive leadership does bring challenges. This leadership model is all about experimenting, discovering new knowledge, and making numerous adjustments throughout your company.



Traditional vs adaptive leadership

In practice, adaptive leadership focuses more on leadership as a practice than as a position. For a manager using adaptive leadership, situations constantly evolve and require both flexibility and innovation.





Adaptive leadership in practice:

Success stories:

- Cheryl Biron
- Travis Bradberry





Six guiding principles

01

Get on the balcony



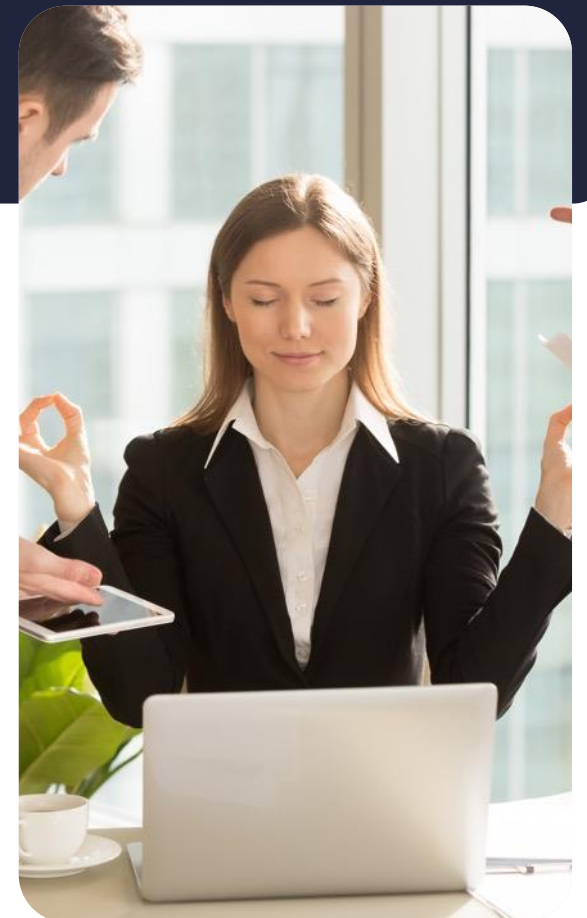
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Identify the adaptive challenges



03

Regulate distress





Six guiding principles

04

Maintain disciplined attention



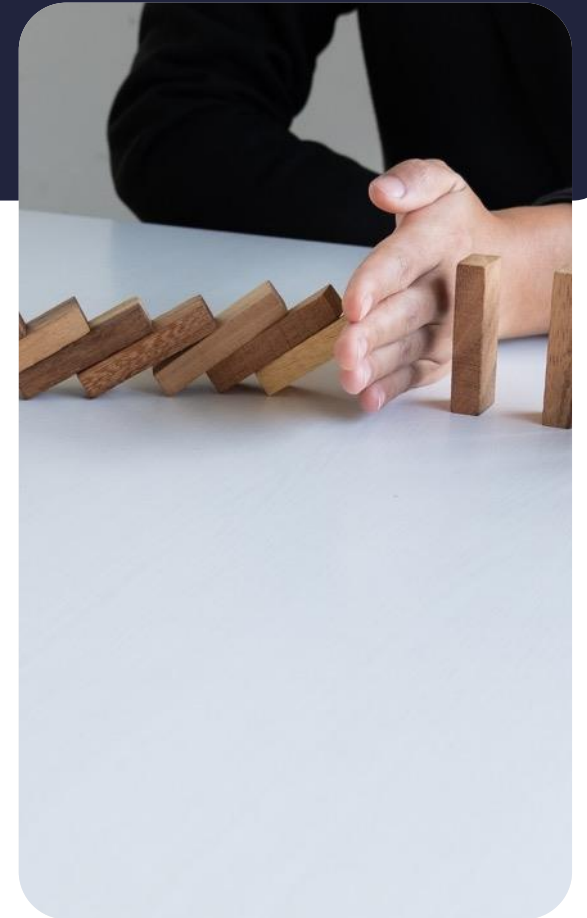
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Get work back to people



06

Protect the voices of leadership



Adaptive leadership example

- Example by Toolshero
- Broadcasters





Authority

- Formal authority
- Informal authority



Key reading

- Heifetz, R. A., Grashow, A., & Linsky, M. (2009). The practice of adaptive leadership: Tools and tactics for changing your organisation and the world. Harvard Business Press.
- Obolensky, M. N. (2014). Complex adaptive leadership: Embracing paradox and uncertainty. Gower Publishing, Ltd.
- Randall, L. M., & Coakley, L. A. (2007). Applying adaptive leadership to successful change initiatives in academia. Leadership & Organisation Development Journal, 28(4), 325-335.